

12.1 Workshop: The Vista Aero Glass Effect



Ever since the first preview, Vista's Aero Glass Effect has made countless people worldwide go "Ooooh...pretty!" In this workshop, we'll learn how to create an Aero-esque panel on our images.

Stage I: The Translucent Distortion

We're going to add (feign, rather) the effect of transparency with a little glassy distortion to the image.

Start by duplicating the Background layer. From the Filters menu, select Distort > Glass. Set the Distortion to 10, the Smoothness to 15, the Texture to Canvas and the Scaling to 70% to give a subtle jitter to the image.

Next, apply a Gaussian Blur from the Filter > Blur menu, and set the Radius to 3. This is what the image is going to look like when viewed from the glass panel.

Stage II: The Panel

For now, turn off the visibility of the Background Copy layer—we'll